

CRM & Software

Custom CRM vs Salesforce vs HubSpot

The honest guide for UK small businesses.
No sales pitch. Just the real comparison.



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Salesforce: built for enterprise.

From £20/user/month. Rises steeply.
Designed for one specific sales methodology.

A 12-person services firm spent £8,000 on Salesforce implementation over 6 months. They used 15% of its functionality. The rest did not match how they worked.

→ **Powerful. But built for someone else.**

HubSpot: good until it is not.

Free tier is genuinely useful.
Proper CRM features start at £41/month.

HubSpot Professional: £41/month in 2022. £89 in 2024. £134 in 2026. For a 5-person team that is £8,040 per year for a tool that almost fits their process.

→ **Their pricing has increased 3x since 2020. It will keep going.**

Custom CRM: built for you.

Your process. Your terminology.
One-time cost. No licence fees.

A recruitment agency replaced their £6,200/year CRM subscription with a custom build costing £4,500. By month 14 they were ahead. Every year after: pure saving.

→ **No monthly fees. No per-user charges. No annual price increases. Ever.**

The honest answer.

Use SaaS when your process is standard.
Build custom when it is specific enough.

If you have tried two or more off-the-shelf tools and neither fits properly, that is the signal. The third tool will not fit either. Build the right one.

→ **The test: can you configure it to fit without significant compromise?**



Mihir Hindocha

Founder · Lexalytic · 15 years experience
Shell · NHS · Warner Bros · Citi

Not sure which fits?

Book a free call.

Tell us your process and current tools.

We will tell you honestly which
approach makes financial sense.

Book a free call

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